

Outside passers can distract a king

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

An outside passed pawn lies far from the main pawn mass. Its value may be the time it forces the enemy king to spend catching it. Your king can then invade the other wing. The race must be calculated precisely.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A queenside passer may draw the defending king away while your king attacks kingside pawns. Sacrificing the passer can be correct if the resulting captures and promotion race favor you, but distance alone does not guarantee success.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you calculate before sacrificing an outside passer?

ANSWER AND REASONING

How many moves the defender needs to capture it, how many pawns your king can win in that time, and whether the final pawn race includes checking promotions.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

A passer can win by distracting, not only by promoting.